

BASIC PRINCIPLES OF COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT

There are basic principles of community development, which also reflect and laying hidden in foundation of every developed society. *William James* the famous psychologist said that every individual is different from every other individual. Hence every group is different from other groups and community due to several reasons of temperament.

The first and foremost principle of community development is to see the local needs. Beside this, the other basic principles of community development are the following.

1. Coordination and Adoption

It is necessary for the social organizer to understand the local needs, the environments and local situations and the basic requirements of the people for development. The positive and negative reaction towards a program should be known. Therefore, such schemes should be taken which are accommodating with the values and norms of the society and coincide the local conditions. The mood of the society should not be agitated and social worker should seek the cooperation and should not offend the society.

Community development is the people's program, the social workers are only the initiators and eventually, have to hand over the program to the people, the social workers stand behind the screen aloof and seeing the people prospers.

2. Choosing the Local Leaders to the Forefront

Some people have high potentialities and some have low. The people with high potentialities and qualities for leadership should be at the top. The principle of dedicated local leadership is the backbone of all development process in a community. This is not a political leader, but a leader of human welfare, a leadership, which is devoted to the altruistic ends. A leader should share with the people, thus choosing a best leader for community development is essential.

3. Three Pronged Attack of Backwardness

Life is a multi dimensional and kaleidoscopic process. If we want better human conditions, then different aspects and dimensions of all problems should be crystal clear in our mind. If there is any social problem, we will first see that what are the causes of the problem. To appoint the real causes, the program should be comprehensive. It should be targeted to achieve a modern and developed polity (civil Government), economy and society. A social worker should have a comprehensive knowledge and approach.

4. Self Help

It means difference of the resources of the community, in developed countries social work is emphasized on the basis of self-help. But in our country due to poverty it is not do so, thus the

government gives money and technical support to make the wheels move; some sort of aid by the government is inevitable.

5. Insight and Psychological Path Ways

Social workers have to follow the psychological pathways. That is the study of the whole social system, the norms and values of the whole social structure. They are supposed to know the ideology and religious hold on the social set up. In our society, sometimes the ideas and behavioral patterns of people are very old and primitive and they have get very strong inclination and grouping on these orthodox principles. For this purpose, psychological pathways are adopted. The social worker has to read the mode of the community.

6. Prediction About the Repercussions

Dynamic communities have vision and deeper insight into the future. Things are calculated and determined in scientific manner. What the society is to face in the coming years are pre-settled and pre-discussed. Problems that are arising are known, and tried upon to overcome before hand. Any social program, that starts in the society (i.e. educational, health etc), its repercussion in the coming time are felt because planning for the future is very necessary and indispensable. Keeping in view these principles, the social worker has to play a certain role i.e. major and minor functions.

- a. **Social. Diagnosis:** A social worker is a social diagnostics and a social doctor. He locates the problem area, blind spots.
- b. **Treatment:** A social worker is a social doctor, mediator and negotiator. He decides among the different people and solves the problem.

Contemporary Principles of Community Development

Community development is sometimes confused with community-based programs, community research and other forms of community interventions. The most significant feature that distinguishes community development from other community work is its principles.

Community Participation

Everyone has a valuable contribution to make and community members can join in at any level. Volunteers and community members are integral to the decision-making, evaluation, provision, participation and direction setting at all levels of the organization.

Community Ownership

Members are actively involved in decision-making and have ownership of the center's activities. A voluntary management committee comprising elected members who live, work or participate in the local community governs each center. The governance model is developmental, working

co-operatively and collaboratively with staff, volunteers, center participants and the wider community, thus generating a range of community benefits.

Lifelong Learning

Learning is integrated into all aspects of center activities, thus building and supporting the personal skills, knowledge, abilities and resilience of people. They develop the health, wellbeing and connection of people and their families, through formal and informal pathways in education, employment and self-development.

Inclusion

The diverse contributions that people make are valued, no matter what their background or varying abilities. Individual and local needs are acknowledged and addressed, often through informal interaction. Identifying these needs and issues through a range of methods is instrumental to informing the planning and development of activities and programs.

Access and Equity

Centers are accessible and welcoming. They promote a fairer distribution of economic resources and power between people by aiming to improve the social, environmental, economic and cultural infrastructures within their communities.

Social Action

Internal and external factors that impact on the local community are analyzed and relationships between individuals, groups and organizations and within the community transformed through collective action.

Advocacy

In meeting individual and group needs, Centers act with, or on behalf of, community members.

Networking

Linking, forming alliances, collaborating and working with individuals, groups, other agencies, government and business are crucial, with interaction between formal and informal methods to achieve connections within the local communities.

Empowerment

A process that respects, values and enhances people's ability to have control over their lives is put into practice. This process encourages people to meet their needs and aspirations in a self-aware and informed way which takes advantage of their skills, experience and potential. Change and growth occurs through informing and empowering individuals and communities.

Self Help

Individuals are supported in coming together in a caring group environment to share information, knowledge, skills and life experience in order that each participant can reach their own personal goals.